

the best b-schools
SPECIALISED COURSES

THE NEW RANGE

With specialisation becoming the buzzword in every field, could B-schools be far behind? They are helping to fulfill the needs of a fast-changing business environment with specialised courses to create a new workforce of domain experts. A guide to the various options available.



■ By Tanvi Saraf

It's the age of super specialisation. Being a vanilla graduate or a 'jack of all trades' is passe. Being master of one is in. Specialists and experts are the most sought after species today with their pay packets being proof enough. A cursory look at the top B-school trends shows there is a demand for specialised courses both from the architects of B-school curricula as well as the aspiring MBA students. While regular MBA programmes are still valued, it is sectoral expertise that will fetch one the extra brownie points. Says Professor Vipul, dean of planning and development at the Indian

Institute of Management (IIM), Lucknow, "An MBA, especially from a good institute, might give you the analytical abilities that you would never be exposed to otherwise while a specialised MBA gives you the expertise and in-depth understanding to ace in your area of work."

Specialised management programmes are basically of two types. First, those specialising in a component of management theory like finance or human resources and these courses are in a high demand among students. Then there are those that apply management principles to a single industry like health care or marketing communications.

Finance

An MBA in Finance has become a popular choice among students and is now being offered by schools like Management Development Institute, Gurgaon, Faculty of Management Studies, Delhi and Symbiosis, Pune

apart from the IIMs. In the first year, students share their curriculum with regular MBA graduates and in the second year, they are steered towards finance-oriented electives. An overall understanding of the business environment combined with a specialisation in finance make these graduates ideal candidates for the banking sector.

International Business

The Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT), Delhi is one of the premier institutes which offers an MBA in International Business. While this has traditionally been a module in all MBA programmes, its newly acquired relevance for the Indian economy has made a specialisation almost mandatory. "With the integration of India in the global economy, young Indian entrepreneurs will find it necessary to have an understanding of international business perspectives," says K.T. Chacko, director, IIFT.